

Initial Project Ideas for Springboard Capstone Project

After speaking with my mentor and looking into the Capstone Project requirements, as well as considering real life business applications and issues faced within our family business, five project ideas were developed. The first three are not related to our family business while the last two are. Each balances external APIs with custom backend development.

1 CineTrack - Personalized Movie & TV Watchlist + Recommendation Platform

This is web application that helps users manage their movie and TV show watchlists across different streaming services. Users can search for titles, create custom lists (Watchlist, Currently Watching, Watched), rate and review content, and receive personalized recommendations based on their tastes.

How will the data be managed? Balances the TMDb (The Movie Database) API, which is free, for complete movie and TV information, combined with my own backend for user authentication, watchlists, ratings, and social features. This idea meets the capstone requirements for frontend and backend logic implementation.

2 WanderLog – Travel Itinerary Planner and Community Tool

This is a social application that enables users to plan, organize, and share travel itineraries. Features include adding destinations, activities, budget tracking, and collaboration with friends or travel companions.

How is the Data managed? Uses external APIs such as OpenWeatherMap for forecasts, along with my own backend to manage user accounts, trips, and shared itineraries.

3 FitConnect – Social Fitness Tracker & Community Platform

A platform where users can log workouts, track progress over time, join or create fitness challenges, and connect with friends for motivation. Includes a social feed for sharing achievements, likes, and comments.

How is the Data managed? Utilizes a public exercise API for workout data such as Ninjas Exercises and will rely primarily on my own backend for user profiles, workout logging, progress charts, posts, and challenges.

4. QuoteBind – Smart Quoting Tool for Bookbinding Services

This is an idea that could be directly implemented within the family business. It is a focused web tool that allows printing shops and photocopy businesses to quickly get instant quotes for bookbinding jobs. Clients enter the book quantity, number of sheets per book, length of the side of the book where the spiral is going to be inserted, thickness and material of covers and other book specifications. They instantly get a

quote for the bookbinding job required. This tool could be efficiently used by the business employees to answer client requests on site significantly shortening the quote request waiting time.

How will the data be managed? Google Books API or Open Library API for book details plus my own backend for quote generation, request submission, quote history, and price calculation algorithms. Directly addresses frequent WhatsApp quote requests from clients.

5. BindFlow – Digital Maquila (Book Binding Production) & Order Management System

BindFlow is a comprehensive web-based system designed to digitize and streamline our current manual processes involving three physical books (Orders book, Quotes book, and Maquila (Book Binding Production) book) plus the heavy paper-based workflow for payments and production tracking.

Problem it solves:

Our business currently relies on separate physical notebooks to track supplies orders, quotes, and bookbinding jobs (maquila). Partial deliveries, pickups, payments, invoicing, and client signatures are all recorded by hand. Paper work orders and signed sheets constantly move between sales staff, managers (for bank payment verification), and the production supervisor. Clients have no real-time visibility into their job status and frequently call or message on WhatsApp for updates. This creates significant administrative burden, high risk of errors, lost paperwork, and inefficiency especially during peak season.

Solution & Features:

Clients can submit supply orders or bookbinding jobs online, with automatic book details pulled via the Google Books API.

Internal dashboard that replaces the three physical books with digital modules for quotes, supplies orders, and full maquila/production tracking (including partial quantities, multiple delivery/pickup dates, payment status, and invoicing).

Payment verification workflow, live job status updates by the production team, digital signature capture for client pickups, and one-click CSV export compatible with Sales Master.

Clients can view real-time status of their jobs and orders.

My Choices:

The following are my choices and the reason as to why they were chosen in descending order:

1. BindFlow: It solves a real life business problem within the family business while meeting all the Springboard Castone Project requirements. However, it might prove to be too complex for my current level of expertise.
2. QuoteBind: Just as the BindFlow application this also solves a real life business issue. However, at first glance it seems too simple for this project's scope.

3. WanderLog: If none of the two first options are a suitable match then this would be it. It still meets all the project's requirements as well as being interesting to work on.